

Facebook is now taking the class to 22 new universities. Further, students in the Academy will be paired with mentors and add code to open source projects. The programme starts with an intensive kick-off weekend at Facebook's headquarters, held at the beginning of the student semester. The code written by a student is reviewed by the mentors, who also teach students about open source. The winter 2014 session is set to start from February onwards.

Google announces stable Chrome 31 for Windows, Mac, Linux and Chrome Frame

Google has announced the release of the stable version of its latest Chrome Web browser, version 31. Officially known as version 31.0.1650.48, it is available



as a free download for Windows, Mac, Linux and Chrome Frame users. This news was shared by Anthony Laforge from the Google Chrome team on the official Chrome releases blog.

The new version comes with around 25 security fixes, wrote Laforge, taking care of a large number of issues in the

browser's code. Additionally, it has a Flash player update to version 11.9.900.152.

Google is now working on the beta release of Chrome version 32, which will be the next to hit stable status. An interesting new feature that comes with the beta version 32 is that users will be able to quickly get a warning on their browser tabs when there is a page that is producing annoying or disruptive sounds through a video clip or some other content, wrote Yuri Wiitala, a Google software engineer, on the Google Chrome blog.

SUSE tool to handle Windows-Linux environments

SUSE Linux recently made it public that it would be launching a tool to allow systems administrations running diverse Windows and Linux environments to use a single interface. This announcement was made on the eve of SUSECon, the annual conference of SUSE Linux. The conference is being held in Orlando, Florida.

The SUSE Manager Management Pack for Microsoft System Centre will act as a sole central console to handle virtual and physical environments, ensuring the good health of patches and installing the required updates.

SUSE was an independent company until it was taken over by Novell in 2003. The company is now functioning as an independent business unit since Novell was taken over by Attachmate Corporation in 2011.

Novell signed a patent licensing deal back in 2006 with Microsoft that resulted in a lot of bad media coverage. After the company went private, the storm seems to have faded away.

In reality, the perk of the single console for management has been credited to the strong integration between SUSE Manager and Microsoft System Centre 2012 R2. As per SUSE officials, such a development came about due to the need for operating in mixed environments.

Users attack policies of Ubuntu

So, how much sharing should actually be allowed when it comes to Linux and open source? Canonical, the company behind Ubuntu, aims at answering this question by exercising more control over the use of its trademark. However, it seems the Ubuntu community is not taking it well, as is evident from an ongoing debate on the site fixubuntu.com.

Facebook Messenger for Android gets a revamp

The update for the Facebook Messenger application for Android-based devices has reportedly become available to users recently. While the update comes automatically, it is also available on the Google Play Store. Further, by downloading the Facebook Messenger app now, you would obviously get the updated version of the app.

The app adds some new features—apart from a completely new design, it has new custom sounds, and it allows users to send messages to other Facebook users without having to add them to their friend list. All that is required is for one to have the person's mobile number.

The app also shows whether a person you are chatting with is using the messenger or the Facebook website. The SMS integration for the app though, has been removed.

CyanogenMod Installer now available on Google Play for free

The CyanogenMod installer is now available on the Google Play Store. Further, the installer can be downloaded for free and facilitates the flashing of CM ROMs on Android-based devices. Users can now bypass the complexity of flashing using the installer.

The installer is currently compatible with 12 devices and their variants, making it compatible with a total of 40 Android-based devices (smartphones and tablets). The company has also promised to increase the support for other devices in the future. According to a blog post by Cyanogen Inc, "We will continue to work on supporting additional devices beyond the initial set, but we are proud to say that we are supporting the majority of flagship models currently on the market."